

Family Game Night Story Card Deck

Fifteen cooperative table cards for screen-free story rounds, quiet choices, and take-home starters.

Audience: Families, homeschool co-ops, library family nights, and classroom celebration tables for ages 7-11.

Format: 15 printable cooperative story cards plus host guide tools

No scary harm, no bullying, no romance, no weapons, no branded characters, no real child profiles.

\$27

Included

- 15 cooperative story card pages
- Host table setup guide
- Round hosting notes
- Quiet participation options
- No-data use notes
- Family handoff notes
- Pack reset notes
- Six cooperative round formats
- Ten take-home story starters
- Eight optional family-share prompts
- Local image-backed world menu
- Provider-ready PDF and ZIP artifact

Start the story round

Table setup

- Print one host copy, one active card stack, and a small take-home starter stack before the family table opens.
- Place pencils, blank half-sheets, and one face-down card pile within adult reach so cards enter the table one at a time.
- Keep extra cards in a host folder until the group finishes the current story step.
- Set a quiet spot at the same table with paper, pencil, and a choice strip for anyone who wants a private start.
- Use plain folders, color tabs, or table symbols for simple sorting when pages need to travel home.
- Choose one adult sample place, one ordinary object, and one small friendly mix-up before the first card is read.

Round hosting

- Open each round by reading one card aloud and naming the first writing blank before anyone adds ideas.
- Model one invented answer, then invite short written, sketched, pointed, or spoken choices.
- Move in small steps: place, helper, object, mix-up, next action, and calm ending.
- Keep the active card visible and leave the rest of the stack covered until the current page has one finished line.
- Invite optional family sharing after writing, with the choice to share a title, object, sketch, or one sentence.
- When the table gets busy, pause on the current blank and offer two simple invented choices.

Quiet participation

- Let anyone join by pointing to a printed choice, circling an option, sketching a clue, or writing one private line.
- Offer a silent card path where the writer fills only the place blank and the object blank.
- Allow a grown-up to write a dictated phrase while the writer chooses the words.
- Make sharing optional and accept a shown sketch, underlined word, or folded page as complete participation.
- Use short check-ins such as choose one object or mark one ending instead of calling on anyone unexpectedly.
- Keep a spare blank card nearby for a fresh start when the current card feels too crowded.

No-data use

- Use invented places, invented helpers, and ordinary objects; personal facts are not needed.
- Keep every card printable, offline, and handled by the host, family, or participant.
- This deck does not require personal lists, recordings, location details, contact details, or private identifiers.
- Use color tabs, table symbols, or plain folders for organization instead of personal labels.
- Keep all finished pages at the table or send them home with the family.

Family handoff

- Send home the finished card page plus one optional take-home story starter.
- Mark one simple follow-up such as add a title, add one clearer detail, or finish the ending.
- Tell families the starter can be completed by pointing, sketching, dictating, or writing one short line.
- Keep home sharing optional and focused on the printed page, invented place, object clue, or title.
- Invite families to save unfinished cards for another calm table moment.

Pack reset

- Collect unused cards first and return them to the host folder before clearing pencils and paper.
- Place finished pages in plain take-home folders or let families carry their own pages.
- Stack the played cards behind the host copy so the next table can begin with a fresh face-down pile.
- Replace bent choice slips, sharpen pencils, and refill blank half-sheets before storing the deck.
- Note which card format worked best on a small host note without recording personal details.

Use one card at a time. Keep every detail invented, printable, and offline.

Image-backed story card menu

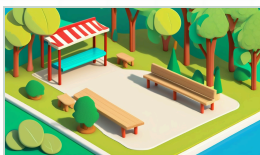
Pick one card at a time. Each card uses an invented world image so family-table details become fiction without personal data or online sharing.



AGES 7-8
Teacup Town Weather Window



AGES 7-9
Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor



AGES 7-9
Pocket Park Notice Board



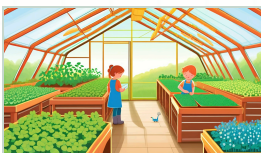
AGES 7-9
Button Bakery Map Mix-Up



AGES 7-9
Penny Path Compass Shop



AGES 8-10
Tidepool Timekeepers Lab



AGES 8-10
Greenhouse Gear Garden



AGES 8-10
Pantry Measurement Mystery



AGES 8-10
Rain Gauge Railway



AGES 8-10
Seed Library Map Room



AGES 10-11
Revision River Ferry



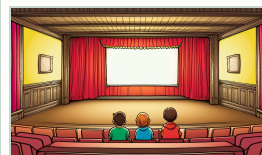
AGES 10-11
Clue Label Tower Museum



AGES 10-11
Compass Craft Academy



AGES 10-11
Almost Invention Workshop



AGES 10-11
Index Card Theater Club

Cooperative round formats and optional family-share prompts

One-Card Story Seed

Best for: A calm first table round where the host wants one shared card and quick individual story starts.

1. Host reads one card aloud and points to the place blank.
2. Each participant chooses an invented place, ordinary object, or helper by writing, sketching, or pointing.
3. Host offers one sample sentence using different invented details.
4. Writers add two short lines to their own page and mark one idea to keep.

Pass the Object Clue

Best for: Family tables that like shared ideas while each writer still keeps a private page.

1. Host places one ordinary object choice in the center and reads the active card prompt.
2. Each participant adds one possible use for the object on a scrap or shared host page.
3. Host repeats the gathered ideas using only invented details.
4. Writers choose one idea and turn it into a story clue on their own card page.

Quiet Sketch Start

Best for: Mixed-energy groups, shy writers, and tables that need a low-noise opening.

1. Host gives everyone the same card and asks for a silent sketch in the first blank.
2. Participants label the sketch with one place word, object word, or action word.
3. Host reads two optional next-step choices for anyone who wants support.
4. Writers turn the sketch and label into one clear opening sentence.

Four-Blank Family Tale

Best for: A longer table round with a clear beginning, middle, and ending path.

1. Host chooses a card with blanks for place, helper, object, and ending.
2. Participants fill one blank at a time while the host keeps the next blank covered.
3. Host pauses after the object blank and asks everyone to choose one next action.
4. Writers finish the ending blank and underline the strongest story detail.

Title Last Round

Best for: A closing round when families want a finished page without a long draft.

1. Host reads a short card and asks writers to complete only the setting and object blanks.
2. Participants add one ending line that makes the small mix-up settle kindly.
3. Host invites each writer to write three title choices privately.
4. Writers circle one title and place the page in a take-home folder.

Table Talk to Tiny Draft

Best for: Homeschool co-op nights, library family events, or classroom celebration tables with adult guidance.

1. Host reads one card and asks for optional table talk about invented places or ordinary objects.
2. Participants choose two table ideas and write them in their own blanks.
3. Host models how the two ideas can become first and next.
4. Writers draft three lines and choose whether to share a title, sketch, or object clue.

Optional share prompts

- Show one title or sketch from the card page: _____.
- Read one sentence aloud, or ask a grown-up to read it: _____.
- Point to one object clue and say how it helps the story: _____.
- Share one invented place detail from the table round: _____.
- Tell which part came first, next, or last: _____.
- Show one word that became clearer after the round: _____.
- Describe one calm ending choice from the invented story: _____.
- Keep the page private today and mark one finished detail: _____.

Take-home story starters

6 MINUTES | SETTING DETAIL

Game Night Place

Invent one cozy story place from tonight's card: _____.

A grown-up can ask what the place looks, sounds, or feels like:
_____.

6 MINUTES | ACTION CHOICE

Helper Next Action

Write what the invented helper does next after the small mix-up:
_____.

A grown-up can ask which action makes the most sense: _____.

8 MINUTES | SEQUENCE

First Next Last Card

Write first, next, and last for the card story path: _____.

A grown-up can point to the step that should become longer: _____.

7 MINUTES | DIALOGUE

Dialogue Pair

Write two short lines between an invented guide and an invented maker:
_____.

A grown-up can read one role while the writer chooses the reply:
_____.

6 MINUTES | VISUAL PLANNING

Sketch and Sentence

Sketch one card idea and write one sentence under it: _____.

A grown-up can ask which part of the sketch belongs in the story:
_____.

7 MINUTES | PLOT CLUE

Object Clue Add-On

Choose one ordinary object from the table and make it a useful clue:
_____.

A grown-up can offer two possible object uses here: _____.

5 MINUTES | MAIN IDEA

Three Tiny Titles

Write three possible titles for the card story: _____.

A grown-up can ask which title gives the clearest clue: _____.

5 MINUTES | REVISION

Clearer Word Swap

Pick one word from the card page and swap in a clearer word: _____.

A grown-up can ask which word became easier to picture: _____.

8 MINUTES | ENDING CHOICE

Kind Ending

Add a calm ending where the helper uses one object wisely: _____.

A grown-up can ask what changed by the end: _____.

7 MINUTES | STORY PLANNING

Next Table Seed

Invent one place, one helper, one object, and one small mix-up for next time:
_____.

A grown-up can add one extra detail to the seed: _____.

Teacup Weather Window Helper

Choose a teacup weather clue, pick the helper at the window, and write what the helper notices first.

Ask the table which tiny weather clue is easiest to picture, then invite each writer to choose a helpful character.

setting detail and character choice

15-minute cooperative, screen-free printable family-table card for younger writers who can add one tiny setting clue and one helper choice.

Adult setup: Print one card per writer, place pencils in the middle, and model one short setting detail before the table writes.



Teacup Town Weather Window

Window Weather The teacup window shows weather shaped like _____. The tiny room smells like _____ when the weather changes. The sill holds a small clue: _____.	Helper Choice The helper at the window is _____. The helper carries _____. The helper decides to check _____ first.	Story Start First, the weather clue moves toward _____. Next, the helper says, "I notice _____." The table story starts when _____.
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Table talk: One setting detail I can add for the family table is _____.

Tiny draft: The helper looks through the window and sees _____.

Round wrap: The detail that made our teacup scene clearer was _____.

Quiet option: Point to a favorite line, then write one more window clue: _____.

Take-home story: At home, add a new weather clue that changes _____.

Spoon Ferry Harbor Cargo Note

Send the spoon ferry across the lunchbox harbor, choose its cargo, and write three calm story steps.

Ask writers to name one harbor detail they can hear, see, or feel before they write the ferry note.

sequence and sensory detail

16-minute cooperative, screen-free printable family-table card for writing a clear ferry sequence with one sound, color, or texture.

Adult setup: Print the card, set out pencils, and place a simple paper harbor path in the middle for writers to point at while planning.



Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor

Harbor Setting The spoon ferry waits beside _____. The lunchbox harbor sound is _____. The dock color I picture is _____.	Cargo Choice The ferry carries _____. The harbor helper checks _____. The careful paper route goes around _____.	Three-Step Note First, the ferry glides past _____. Next, the cargo helper notices _____. Last, the dock note says _____.
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Table talk: The sensory detail I can offer the table is _____.

Tiny draft: The spoon ferry carries _____ across the harbor.

Round wrap: The step that helped our ferry story move forward was _____.

Quiet option: Trace the ferry path silently, then write one cargo clue: _____.

Take-home story: At home, add one more harbor sound or color: _____.

Pocket Park Notice Board Helper

- Create a pocket park notice, choose the helper who reads it, and write what the helper says.
- Ask the table what kind of small park job a helper could do, then invite one short spoken sentence.

dialogue and character choice

15-minute cooperative, screen-free printable family-table card for inventing one useful notice and one friendly spoken line.

Adult setup: Print the card, offer pencils and blank paper strips, and remind writers that every notice is invented for the story world.



Pocket Park Notice Board

Notice Board The pocket park notice asks for _____. The notice is posted beside _____. The board has a small drawing of _____.	Park Helper The helper who reads the notice is _____. The helper brings _____. The helper chooses this job because _____.	Spoken Line The helper says, "I can help with _____." The next kind reply is _____. The notice board changes when _____.
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Table talk: A helpful notice idea for our park is _____.

Tiny draft: The pocket park helper says, "_____."

Round wrap: The spoken line that made our park helper clearer was _____.

Quiet option: Skip reading aloud and copy one notice line here: _____.

Take-home story: At home, add one new pocket park notice about _____.

Button Bakery Map Fix

Fix the bakery map by choosing one mixed-up clue, adding a direction word, and writing the clearer route.

Ask writers to point to one bakery object on the card and make the route more specific before the round wraps.

revision and clear directions

17-minute cooperative, screen-free printable family-table card for replacing one vague map clue with a clearer bakery detail.

Adult setup: Print the card, set out pencils, and offer beside, past, near, and around as gentle direction words.



Button Bakery Map Mix-Up

Bakery Map The crumb path begins near _____. The button baker looks past _____. The mixed-up clue points toward _____.	Clearer Clue I can replace a vague word with _____. The better direction word is _____. The bakery detail that helps readers is _____.	Fixed Route First, follow the crumb path beside _____. Next, turn around _____. The fixed map ends at _____.
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Table talk: The clearer direction I can add is _____.

Tiny draft: The button baker fixes the map by changing _____.

Round wrap: The revision that made our route easier to follow was _____.

Quiet option: Draw one arrow first, then write the clearer clue: _____.

Take-home story: At home, revise one bakery map clue into _____.

Penny Path Compass Shop Ending

- Follow the penny compass, choose where the route ends, and write what the shop helper says there.
- Ask the table which ending feels complete, then have each writer add one short shop-helper sentence.

ending choice and dialogue

16-minute cooperative, screen-free printable family-table card for choosing a gentle ending and adding one compass-shop line of dialogue.

Adult setup: Print the card, place pencils nearby, and invite writers to choose a calm ending that finishes the route on paper.



Penny Path Compass Shop

Compass Setting The penny compass points toward _____. The shop shelf holds _____. The path under the counter looks like _____.	Shop Helper The compass shop helper carries _____. The helper says, "This path leads to _____." The helper pauses beside _____.	Ending Choice The route could end with a discovered object: _____. The route could end with a helpful note: _____. I choose this ending because _____.
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Table talk: The ending choice I can offer the family table is _____.

Tiny draft: At the compass shop, the helper says, "_____."

Round wrap: The ending that made our Penny Path story feel complete was _____.

Quiet option: Choose the ending silently, then write one compass clue: _____.

Take-home story: At home, add one more ending detail about _____.

Tidepool Timekeepers Lab Setting Card

Choose the timekeeper's job, collect three setting clues, and write the first small moment of the story.

Ask for one sight, one sound, and one texture, then let the writer choose which details belong on the page.

Setting detail and sensory observation

Ages 8-10 cooperative family-table round where the group builds one calm tidepool lab scene.

Adult setup: Print the card, place one pencil in the center, and invite the table to offer tiny tidepool details aloud.



Tidepool Timekeepers Lab

Lab Setting The tidepool lab is tucked beside _____. The clearest sound in the lab is _____. One texture the timekeeper touches is _____.	Timekeeper Choice The timekeeper decides to check _____. The tiny tool on the table is _____. The choice matters because _____.	Opening Moment First, the tidepool clock shows _____. Next, the lab helper notices _____. The scene begins when _____.
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One tidepool detail our table agrees to use is _____.

My first sentence begins with _____.

The round wraps up with the timekeeper choosing _____.

If I want a quiet turn, I can circle the detail _____.

At home, the tidepool lab can open again when _____.

Greenhouse Gear Garden Character Card

Pick a gear-garden helper, give the helper a clear choice, and write one line of dialogue.

Invite short suggestions for what the helper sees, wants, and says in a friendly greenhouse moment.

Character choice and dialogue

Ages 8-10 cooperative family-table card for choosing one garden helper and one shared speaking line.

Adult setup: Print the card, set out pencils, and ask the table to name gentle greenhouse jobs before writing starts.



Greenhouse Gear Garden

Garden Helper The greenhouse helper carries _____. The helper cares most about _____. One gear in the garden moves near _____.	Choice Point The helper can turn toward _____. The helper can pause beside _____. The kinder choice is to _____.	Speaking Line The helper says, "I notice _____." Another table idea for dialogue is _____. The line shows the helper feels _____.
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One greenhouse job we can picture together is _____.

My dialogue sentence will say, "_____."

The round wraps up after the helper decides to _____.

If I want a quiet turn, I can write the helper's object as _____.

At home, the gear garden grows a new scene around _____.

Pantry Measurement Mystery Sequence Card

Order the pantry clues, add one exact measurement detail, and draft the next step in the scene.

Ask what should happen first, what changes next, and which small measurement detail makes the scene clearer.

Sequence and exact measurement detail

Ages 8-10 cooperative family-table card for ordering three pantry clues into one short scene.

Adult setup: Print the card and invite the table to choose three harmless pantry objects as pretend story clues.



Pantry Measurement Mystery

Pantry Clues The first pantry clue sits beside _____. The second clue measures _____. The third clue points toward _____.	Clear Order First, the shelf helper checks _____. Next, the measuring cup shows _____. After that, the helper moves toward _____.	Next Step Draft The scene continues when _____. The exact amount I will include is _____. The next helpful action is _____.
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One pantry clue our table can place in order is _____.

My sequence sentence starts with _____.

The round wraps up when the pantry helper reaches _____.

If I want a quiet turn, I can number the clue _____.

At home, the pantry scene can continue with _____.

Rain Gauge Railway Sensory Route Card

- Choose the railway route, add two sensory details, and decide where the ending should stop.
- Ask what the gauge shows, what the railway feels like, and which stop gives the story a satisfying ending.

Sensory detail, sequence, and ending choice

Ages 8-10 cooperative family-table round where the group builds one weather route together.

Adult setup: Print the card, invite one gentle weather detail from the table, and keep the route short.



Rain Gauge Railway

Gauge Reading The rain gauge shows _____. The air around the platform smells like _____. The railway track shines near _____.	Route Sequence First, the conductor checks _____. Then, the route bends toward _____. Before the last stop, the rider notices _____.	Ending Choice The story can end at _____. The ending feels complete because _____. One final detail to add is _____.
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One railway sound our table can use is _____.

My route sentence includes the detail _____.

The round wraps up at the railway stop called _____.

If I want a quiet turn, I can choose the ending place _____.

At home, the rain gauge route can continue toward _____.

Seed Library Map Room Revision Card

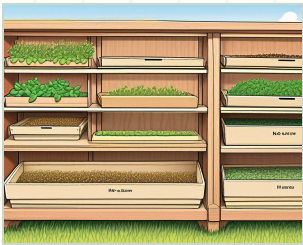
Pick a seed map, write a short route, revise one vague word, and choose the ending doorway.

Ask which noun should be more exact, which route detail should move earlier, and where the story should end.

Map detail, revision, and ending choice

Ages 8-10 cooperative family-table card for revising one map scene with clearer details.

Adult setup: Print the card, ask the table for one map-room object, and remind writers they can improve one sentence.



Map Room Detail The seed map is spread across _____. The clearest label on the map says _____. The map room smells like _____.	Revision Spot A vague word I can replace is _____. A stronger noun for the sentence is _____. The revised detail helps readers picture _____.	Ending Doorway The route leads to _____. The final seed packet shows _____. The ending line should leave the reader with _____.
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One map-room detail our table wants to keep is _____.

My revised sentence will change _____ to _____.

The round wraps up when the seed map points to _____.

If I want a quiet turn, I can underline the word _____.

At home, the seed library story can end near _____.

Revision River Ferry Ending Switch

Draft a river scene, revise one sentence, and choose an ending that echoes an earlier clue.

Ask which detail should return at the dock and which extra sentence can be trimmed.

Revise a shared table idea by choosing the clearest ending detail.

Upper-age cooperative family-table card for a calm paper-and-pencil story round.

Adult setup: Set one printed card near the pencils and ask the table to choose one ferry detail everyone may borrow.



Revision River Ferry

Ferry Start The ferry carries a small object shaped like _____. The river setting feels _____ because of one detail. The table clue everyone may borrow is _____.	Revision Turn My first ending idea is _____. One sentence I can make clearer is _____. The detail that should return near the dock is _____.	Dock Ending The ferry reaches the dock when _____. My revised final image is _____. The ending choice I like best is _____.
Tell the table one detail you kept after revising: _____.		
Tiny draft: The ferry changed course when _____.		
This round made my ending clearer by _____.		
Quiet option: circle one sentence to revise and copy it here: _____.		
Take-home story starter: A ferry ticket with a revised note says _____.		

Clue Label Tower Sensory Case

Choose one clue, add a sensory detail, and write a label that points a reader into the scene.

Ask which clue belongs in the first sentence and which detail is only background.

Select precise setting details and turn them into a concise story label.

Upper-age cooperative family-table card for screen-free observation, sorting, and short writing.

Adult setup: Place the card in the center and invite the table to name one quiet museum case, shelf, or tower detail.



Clue Label Tower Museum

Case Clues The tower case holds something that looks like _____. A sound, texture, or color near it is _____. The clue the table can reuse is _____.	Label Focus The label should help readers notice _____. The detail I will leave in the background is _____. The strongest setting word on my card is _____.	Museum Scene My story label begins with _____. The scene changes when someone notices _____. The label makes the setting feel _____.
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Share one setting word the table could borrow: _____.

Tiny draft: The tower label pointed toward _____.

This round helped me choose the clearest clue: _____.

Quiet option: write only your final invented label here: _____.

Take-home story starter: A label on an ordinary shelf explains _____.

Compass Craft Academy Route Choice

Plan a three-stop route, choose what the main character decides, and draft the turning sentence.

Ask which stop changes the plan and which map word helps readers follow the sequence.

Build sequence with a clear route, character choice, and turning point.

Upper-age cooperative family-table card for mapping a short scene with three connected steps.

Adult setup: Invite the table to agree on one starting place, one turn, and one finish before anyone writes.



Compass Craft Academy

Route Map

The route starts beside _____.

The middle stop reveals _____.

The finish point waits near _____.

Choice Point

The main character chooses to _____.

The reason for that choice is _____.

A compass word that shows the next step is _____.

Sequence Draft

First, the route moves through _____.

Next, the plan changes because _____.

Finally, the ending lands at _____.

Tell the table which stop changed the route: _____.

Tiny draft: The compass pointed next to _____.

This round made my sequence clearer by _____.

Quiet option: draw three route dots and write the middle turn: _____.

Take-home story starter: A hallway map at home leads from _____ to _____.

Almost Invention Workshop Test Note

Invent a nearly useful paper tool, write three ordered steps, and revise one test note.

Ask where the directions need a clearer verb, label, or sensory detail.

Use ordered steps, sensory detail, and revision to explain a paper invention.

Upper-age cooperative family-table card for inventing a simple paper-only idea together.

Adult setup: Ask the table to pick one simple household problem for an imaginary paper tool to help explain.



Almost Invention Workshop

Workshop Idea

The paper-only invention is called _____.

It is meant to help with _____.

The texture, color, or shape detail is _____.

Step Order

Step one tells the reader to _____.

Step two changes the tool by _____.

Step three checks whether _____.

Test Note

The part that almost works is _____.

The direction I should revise is _____.

The final test note says _____.

Share one verb that made the directions clearer: _____.

Tiny draft: The almost-invention worked better after _____.

This round helped me revise the step that says _____.

Quiet option: revise one direction silently and write it here: _____.

Take-home story starter: A paper tool on the kitchen table almost solves _____.

Index Card Theater Dialogue Turn

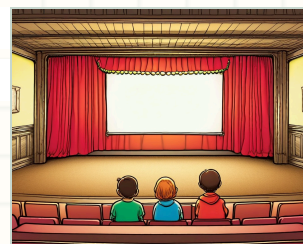
Write two lines of dialogue, show what a character chooses, and end with a clear scene shift.

Ask what the first line expects and how the reply changes the scene direction.

Write concise dialogue that reveals character choice and ending direction.

Upper-age cooperative family-table card for a short two-voice scene on printable cards.

Adult setup: Invite the table to choose one setting cue and one shared object before writers draft two spoken lines.



Index Card Theater Club

Stage Cards

The tiny theater setting is _____.

The shared object on the table is _____.

A quiet action before the dialogue is _____.

Dialogue Turn

The first spoken line is _____.

The reply changes the plan by _____.

The character choice behind the reply is _____.

Scene Shift

The scene turns when _____.

The final stage detail is _____.

The ending direction points toward _____.

Share the reply that changed your scene: _____.

Tiny draft: The second line changed everything because _____.

This round made my dialogue stronger by _____.

Quiet option: write only the two spoken lines here: _____.

Take-home story starter: Two index cards on a table begin a scene about _____.